There is no wild here. The landscape is what we keep doing to it.

F2

Chand Baori stepwell. Wide view of the geometric stepped walls.

images/F2.jpg

F4

Lake varve core. Tight crop of a banded sediment core.

images/F4.jpg

M3

Ceramic House. Raking-light close-up of printed tile relief (not the full elevation).

images/M3.jpg

C2

Earthships. Earthship exterior in the desert.

images/C2.jpg

M2

Mud Frontiers. Printer extruding local soil in the field.

2.jpg

hoto of the concrete channel.

C3

Bullitt Center. Building exterior or its rainwater system (alt: Roman impluvium).

images/C3.jpg

F3

A Tour of the Monuments of Passaic, New Jersey. Pipes dischar
(The Fountain Monument).

images/F3.jpg

F1

Touch Sanitation. Ukeles shaking hands with a New York City sanitation worker.

images/F1.jpg

M1

Ricola Kräuterzentrum. Close-up of the rammed earth wall strata.

images/M1.jpg

C1

Manifesto of the Third Landscape. Overgrown abandoned lot.

images/BASE.jpg

POSITION

Push into the artificial, not between. The Arroyo Seco is fully engineered: dams, channelization, debris basins, yearly sediment removal. The only living landscape in Los Angeles is a maintained one. Maintenance that is hidden gets abandoned; made public, it becomes productive culture.

MATERIAL

Landscape becomes manufactured material. Sediment becomes earth, earth becomes printed ceramic. Tiles printed each year from that year's sediment form a facade that records the watershed in bands, like a geological core.

THOM MAYNE

What if every building maintained its own water?

FOR

Distributed responsibility scales maintenance citywide.

AGAINST

Private on-site systems are hidden maintenance, the kind that gets abandoned. Sediment is a watershed problem no single building can solve.

SYNTHESIS

Buildings maintain their own rain. Public nodes handle what no building can (sediment, debris, treatment) and make that work visible. Two scales, one system.

BASE BASE

Los Angeles River channelization under construction, U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, late 1930s

The landscape is engineered. There is no "natural" Arroyo to restore.

F1 FOR

Touch Sanitation, Mierle Laderman Ukeles, 1979 to 1980

Maintenance labor made public becomes culture, not invisible service.

F2 FOR

Chand Baori stepwell, Abhaneri, Rajasthan, 9th century

Collective water infrastructure that fell into neglect once piped water made the work invisible. The thesis as historical evidence.

F3 FOR

A Tour of the Monuments of Passaic, New Jersey, Robert Smithson, 1967

Infrastructure read as monument; entropy and sediment as cultural subject.

F4 FOR / MATERIAL

Lake varve core, Annual sediment layers

Sediment as a time record. Source for a facade that archives each year's sediment.

M1 MATERIAL

Ricola Kräuterzentrum, Herzog & de Meuron with Martin Rauch, 2014

Excavated earth refined into construction that shows its own making.

M2 MATERIAL

Mud Frontiers, Rael San Fratello / Emerging Objects, 2019 to 2020

Site earth printed directly into form. Proof that local soil can be printed.

M3 MATERIAL

Ceramic House, Studio RAP, 2023

Uniquely 3D printed ceramic facade. Direct precedent for a sediment tile facade.

C1 AGAINST

Manifesto of the Third Landscape, Gilles Clément, 2004

Value in unmanaged land. The position the thesis argues against.

C2 AGAINST

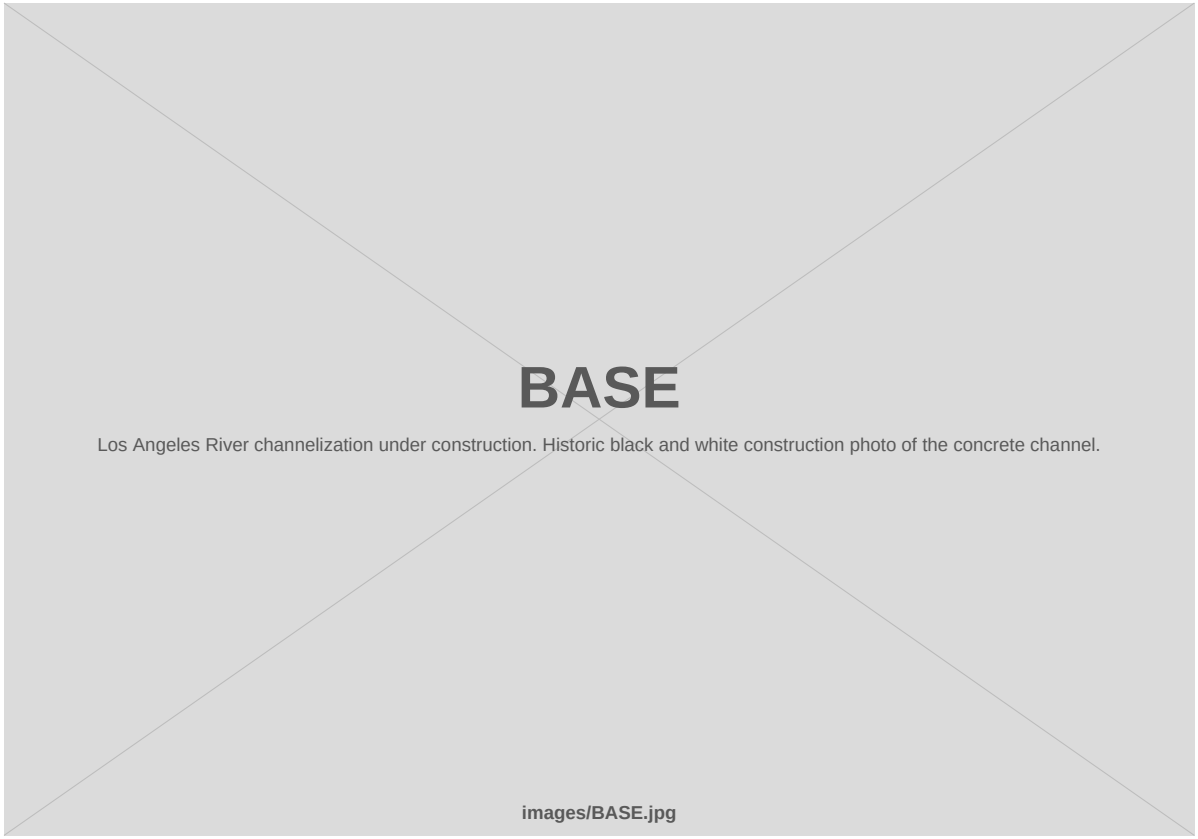
Earthships, Michael Reynolds, 1970s onward

Total self-sufficiency per building, zero civic life. The isolation risk of "every building maintains its own water."

C3 AGAINST / MAYNE

Bullitt Center, Miller Hull Partnership, 2013

A building that handles its own water on site. The strongest case for Mayne's distributed model, and its limit: the work stays private.



BASE

BASE

INFORMATION

Los Angeles River channelization under construction

U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, late 1930s

- U.S. Army Corps of Engineers with LA County Flood Control
- Begun after the March 1938 flood
- By 1960 most of the river and the Arroyo Seco run in concrete

RELEVANCE

The landscape is engineered. There is no "natural" Arroyo to restore.

PROJECT

Sets the ground for the whole position. Restoration assumes a prior nature to return to. In the Arroyo Seco that nature was replaced by a flood control machine eighty years ago, so the only honest move is to design the machine's upkeep, not to hide it under planting.

F1

FOR

INFORMATION

Touch Sanitation

Mierle Laderman Ukeles, 1979 to 1980

- Performance across all 59 New York sanitation districts
- Ukeles shook hands with every sanitation worker, roughly 8,500 people
- "Thank you for keeping New York City alive"
- Follows Manifesto for Maintenance Art 1969!

RELEVANCE

Maintenance labor made public becomes culture, not invisible service.

PROJECT

The founding text for the argument that visibility creates a constituency. Work that the public sees and thanks is harder to defund. The sheet places it on top of the material sequence because labor is what turns sediment into material: nothing in the loop happens without a crew.

F2

FOR

INFORMATION

Chand Baori stepwell

Abhaneri, Rajasthan, 9th century

- Stepwell of about 3,500 steps over thirteen levels
- Collective water storage, bathing and gathering space
- Stepwells fell out of use when piped water and tube wells arrived

RELEVANCE

Collective water infrastructure that fell into neglect once piped water made the work invisible. The thesis as historical evidence.

PROJECT

Proof that civic water architecture can be monumental and social, and proof of the failure mode. When the work moved into pipes, the public stopped seeing it, and the structure lost its constituency. The same thing happened behind Devil's Gate Dam from 1994 to 2009.

F3

FOR

INFORMATION

A Tour of the Monuments of Passaic, New Jersey

Robert Smithson, 1967

- Photo essay published in Artforum, December 1967
- Instamatic photographs of a bridge, pumping derrick and outfall pipes
- Introduces "ruins in reverse": structures that rise into ruin

RELEVANCE

Infrastructure read as monument; entropy and sediment as cultural subject.

PROJECT

Gives permission to read a debris basin or outfall as a monument rather than an eyesore. Smithson treats entropy as the real subject of the landscape, which is the condition of a watershed that fills with sediment every winter.

F4

Lake varve core. Tight crop of a banded sediment core.

images/F4.jpg

F4

FOR / MATERIAL

INFORMATION

Lake varve core

Annual sediment layers

- A varve is one year of lake sediment: a light summer silt and a dark winter clay
- Counted like tree rings to date climate and flood events
- Method from Gerard De Geer's Swedish clay varve chronology (1912)

RELEVANCE

Sediment as a time record. Source for a facade that archives each year's sediment.

PROJECT

The model for the facade. If each year's sediment is printed into that year's tiles, the elevation becomes a core sample of the Arroyo: fire years, wet years and lapses in maintenance all read as bands. Paired at equal scale with M3 on the pile-up.

M1

MATERIAL

INFORMATION

Ricola Kräuterzentrum

Herzog & de Meuron with Martin Rauch, 2014

- Herb processing center, Laufen, Switzerland
- Prefabricated rammed earth blocks made from regional excavated earth
- Strata and erosion left visible as the finish

RELEVANCE

Excavated earth refined into construction that shows its own making.

PROJECT

Step one of the material sequence: excavated earth, normally hauled away as waste, becomes a wall. The banding is a record of how it was made, which is the quality the sediment tiles should keep.

M2

MATERIAL

INFORMATION

Mud Frontiers

Rael San Fratello / Emerging Objects, 2019 to 2020

- 3D printed adobe structures in the San Luis Valley and the U.S.-Mexico borderlands
- Portable clay printer fed with soil dug on site
- Links printing to traditional adobe craft

RELEVANCE

Site earth printed directly into form. Proof that local soil can be printed.

PROJECT

Step two: shows that raw local earth can go straight into a printer without an industrial clay body. The test the node's lab would run on Arroyo sediment each year before it is printed.

M3

MATERIAL

INFORMATION

Ceramic House

Studio RAP, 2023

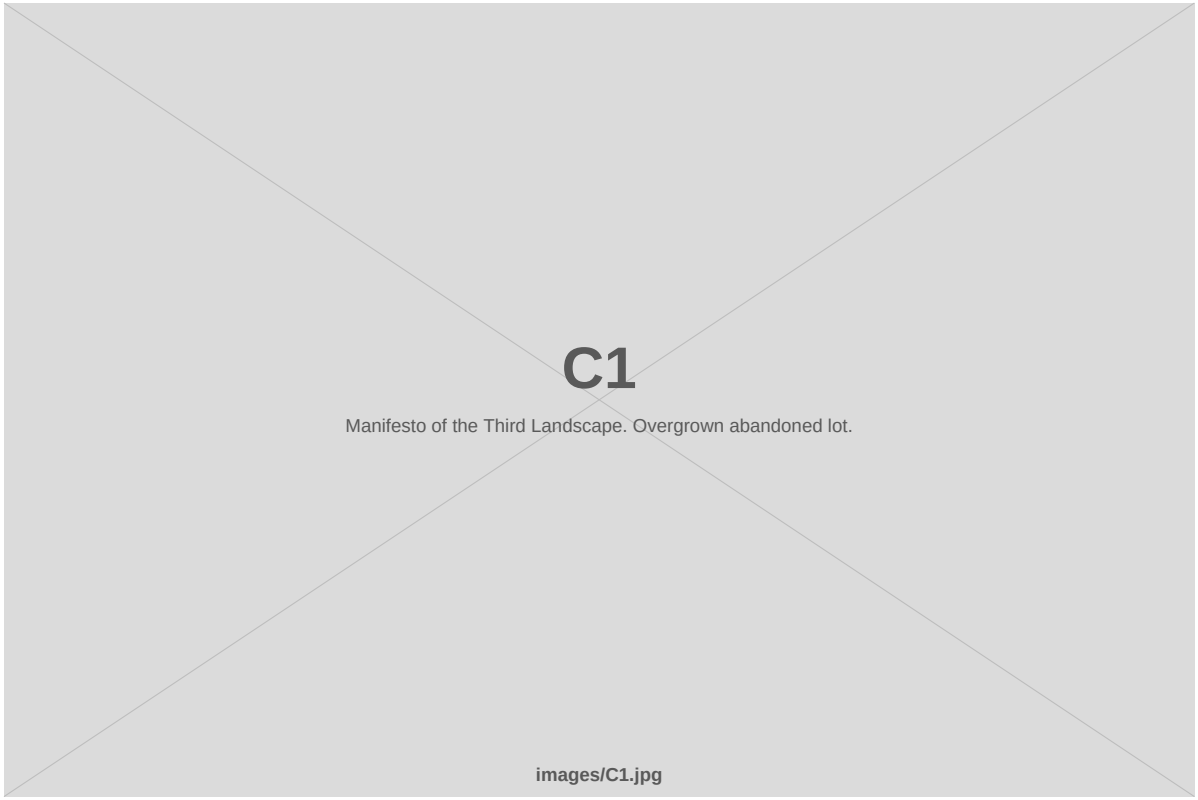
- Shopfront facade, Amsterdam
- Thousands of individually 3D printed, glazed ceramic tiles
- Each tile computed and printed as a unique piece

RELEVANCE

Uniquely 3D printed ceramic facade. Direct precedent for a sediment tile facade.

PROJECT

Step three and the direct precedent. Proves a facade of unique printed tiles is buildable today. The position adds what Studio RAP does not: the clay comes from the watershed, and its variation is data, not ornament.



C1

AGAINST

INFORMATION

Manifesto of the Third Landscape

Gilles Clément, 2004

- Manifeste du Tiers paysage, Paris, 2004
- The third landscape: abandoned and unmanaged ground
- Argues these spaces are refuges for biodiversity

RELEVANCE

Value in unmanaged land. The position the thesis argues against.

PROJECT

The strongest counter-position. Clément would say leave the basin alone and let it go wild. In the Arroyo Seco, abandonment does not produce wilderness; it produces a full reservoir and a debris flow. Placed at the bottom edge, partly buried.

C2

AGAINST

INFORMATION

Earthships

Michael Reynolds, 1970s onward

- Greater World community, Taos, New Mexico
- Tire and earth walls, rainwater catchment, on-site greywater and power
- Designed to operate fully off the grid

RELEVANCE

Total self-sufficiency per building, zero civic life. The isolation risk of "every building maintains its own water."

PROJECT

Mayne's prompt taken to the limit. Each house looks after itself and owes nothing to anyone else, so maintenance never becomes a shared or public act. The position keeps the self-reliance and rejects the isolation.

Bullitt Center. Building exterior or its rainwater system (alt: Roman impluvium).

images/C3.jpg

C3

AGAINST / MAYNE

INFORMATION

Bullitt Center

Miller Hull Partnership, 2013

- Seattle; certified under the Living Building Challenge
- Roof rainwater stored in a basement cistern and treated for use on site
- Composting toilets; greywater treated on the building

RELEVANCE

A building that handles its own water on site. The strongest case for Mayne's distributed model, and its limit: the work stays private.

PROJECT

Where the synthesis comes from. The building handles its own rain well, but the cistern is in the basement and the work is invisible. It cannot take on sediment, debris or a watershed. That is the job of the public node.